

Kun Wang

Computational Biology Researcher | Stochastic Modeling & Single-Cell Lineage Dynamics

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Introduction

PhD candidate in computational biology with training in probability theory and mathematical statistics. Specializes in stochastic dynamical modeling and statistical inference for phylogeny-resolved single-cell data. Developed computational frameworks integrating lineage tracing and transcriptomics to reconstruct developmental dynamics and infer cell fate decisions. Led the development of PhyloVelo (*Nature Biotechnology*, 2023) and scPhyloX (*Cell Systems*, 2025), with additional contributions to mitochondrial lineage tracing analysis (*Genome Biology*, 2025). First author of a review article accepted in *Nature Reviews Genetics*.

Education

PhD	Xiamen University , Probability Theory and Mathematical Statistics - Thesis: Dynamical Modeling and Cell Fate Inference from Single-Cell Multimodal Lineage Tracing Data - Advisor: Prof. Da Zhou	Xiamen, China Sept 2022 – June 2026
MS	Xiamen University , Probability Theory and Mathematical Statistics Advisor: Prof. Da Zhou	Xiamen, China Sept 2019 – June 2022
BS	Ocean University of China , Mathematics and Applied Mathematics	Qingdao, China Sept 2015 – June 2019

Experience

Shenzhen Institutes of Advanced Technology , Visiting Research Student - Advisor: Dr. Zheng Hu - Conducted research on lineage tracing and single-cell dynamics. - Developed stochastic models integrating phylogeny and transcriptomics.	Shenzhen, China Aug 2020 – June 2026 5 years 11 months
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Research Contributions

PhyloVelo PhyloVelo infers cell state transitions using lineage-resolved single-cell data. - Published in <i>Nature Biotechnology</i> (2023). - Improves velocity estimation by incorporating lineage structure. - Robustly maps developmental trajectories across diverse biological systems.	June 2021 – June 2023
scPhyloX scPhyloX infers tissue growth dynamics from single-cell lineage trees - Published in <i>Cell Systems</i> (2025). - Quantifies diverse stem cell growth rates across different tissues. - Detects Darwinian selection and expansion of advantageous tumor clones.	Oct 2020 – Mar 2025

Skills

Programming: Python(Pytorch, Pyro, PyMC), R (Seurat), Matlab, Mathematica

Research Areas: Stochastic dynamical modeling, Variational inference, Single-cell lineage tracing, Transcriptomic analysis

Selected Publications

- PhyloVelo Enhances Transcriptomic Velocity Field Mapping Using Monotonically Expressed Genes** May 2024
Kun Wang, Liangzhen Hou, et al.
[10.1038/s41587-023-01887-5](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41587-023-01887-5) (*Nature Biotechnology*)
- Single-Cell Phylodynamic Inference of Stem Cell Differentiation and Tumor Evolution** May 2025
Kun Wang, Zhaolian Lu, et al.
[10.1016/j.cels.2025.101244](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cels.2025.101244) (*Cell Systems*)
- Computational approaches for multimodal lineage tracing** Apr 2026
Kun Wang, Xionglei He, Zheng Hu
(*Nature Reviews Genetics*, Accepted)
- Clonal Expansion Dictates the Efficacy of Mitochondrial Lineage Tracing in Single Cells** Jan 2025
Xin Wang*, **Kun Wang***, et al.
[10.1186/s13059-025-03540-7](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13059-025-03540-7) (*Genome Biology*)
- Polyclonal-to-Monoclonal Transition in Colorectal Precancerous Evolution** Jan 2024
Zhaolian Lu, Shanlan Mo, et al.
[10.1038/s41586-024-08133-1](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41586-024-08133-1) (*Nature*)

Selected Honors

- Top 10 Bioinformatics Advances in China, 2023
- Best Oral Presentation, GPB Omics & Bioinformatics Frontiers Symposium, 2023
- BYD Scholarship, 2026
- SIAT Dean's Scholarship, 2023

Invited Talks

1. GPB Omics & Bioinformatics Frontiers Symposium 2023: "PhyloVelo enhances transcriptomic velocity field mapping using monotonically expressed genes" (Best Oral Presentation)
2. 2023 Genomics & AI: First Author Forum: "PhyloVelo enhances transcriptomic velocity field mapping using monotonically expressed genes"
3. 2025 Genomics & AI: First Author Forum: "Single-cell phylodynamic inference of stem cell differentiation and tumor evolution"
4. 2025 Quantitative Biology: Mathematical Modeling and Statistical Inference Workshop: "Stochastic modeling of cell fate dynamics in lineage-traced single-cell data"